



Antyodaya Foundation: Transforming Rural India Through Education and Empowerment

In the heart of rural India, a transformative initiative is reshaping thousands of lives through education, empowerment, and sustainable development. The Antyodaya Foundation, led by IIT alumnus Mahendra Mehta who left a promising career in the USA, demonstrates how targeted grassroots interventions can foster lasting social change across villages in our country.

The remarkable journey of the Antyodaya Foundation, Mumbai began with Mahendra Mehta, an IIT alumnus who left his life in the United States to pursue a vision of transforming millions of underserved families in India. Through innovative yet cost-effective initiatives, the Foundation addresses critical systemic gaps in rural development.

In merely five years since its establishment, the Foundation has extended its reach to over 1,500 villages across 50 districts in 8 states. With focused determination, it aims to elevate 2,000 families above the poverty line annually. The Foundation's comprehensive approach includes establishing toy banks, providing free coaching for scholarship examinations, and strengthening digital infrastructure in government schools across India, primarily serving students from economically disadvantaged backgrounds.



Mahendra Mehta
Antyodaya Foundation

ENABLING SCHOLARSHIPS FOR TALENTED STUDENTS

A cornerstone of the Foundation's mission is preparing students for NMMS scholarships (worth Rs 48,000 per student) and admission to centrally-managed Navodaya schools, renowned for their quality education and holistic development approach, where the government invests over Rs 30 lakhs per student.

To achieve this, the Foundation conducts free coaching classes across hundreds of government schools, distributes study materials, and administers mock tests for nationwide competitive examinations. To date, this initiative has generated benefits exceeding Rs 125 crores for over 1,500 students—a figure that continues to grow. The Foundation maintains its commitment to nurturing these talented students, preparing them for competitive and civil services examinations.

WOMEN'S EMPOWERMENT THROUGH ECONOMIC INDEPENDENCE

The Foundation prioritizes rural women's empowerment through comprehensive skill development programs. Offering village-based training in tailoring, beautician services, and cooking eliminates travel barriers. Annually, over 500 women receive training, enabling them to earn between Rs 3,000 and Rs 10,000 monthly, fostering financial independence and improving marriage prospects for unmarried women.

These women also contribute to environmental sustainability by crafting eco-friendly bags during their leisure time. The Foundation provides destitute widows with free sewing machines, offering them a dignified means of livelihood.



TOY BANKS: IGNITING JOYFUL LEARNING

Recognizing that millions of underprivileged students in government schools lack access to toys essential for cognitive development, the Foundation initiated Smart Toy Banks. Guided by the principle that "No One Can Teach Children Better Than Toys/Games," this initiative has successfully reached 1,500 villages. The toy banks are sustainably maintained through donations from Mumbai households and regular contributions from teachers, ensuring children maintain their enthusiasm for learning.

This initiative has significantly boosted school enrollment rates. Additionally, the Foundation operates Antyodaya Balwadis in slum areas, providing age-appropriate education to integrate underprivileged children into mainstream society.



STRENGTHENING DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

The Foundation enhances learning environments by providing smart TVs, printers, and loudspeakers to schools. These resources create interactive learning spaces where students can explore complex topics through animations and videos. Under the trustees' guidance, over 225 schools across five states have received smart TVs. Additionally, more than 75 schools have been equipped with WiFi printers over five years, facilitating the distribution of teaching materials and mock test worksheets.

A VISION FOR INCLUSIVE DEVELOPMENT

The Foundation's five-point initiative encompasses education, skill development, clothing distribution, support for disabled individuals, and economic assistance for skilled widows, targeting comprehensive improvement in the lives of "Antyodaya Families" from lower-income backgrounds.

With unwavering commitment, the Foundation pursues its goal of providing employment to 500 individuals and scholarships to 1,000 students annually. This mission thrives through generous support from IIT alumni, trustees—notably Sanjay Bordia and Surendra Lavti—friends, family, philanthropists, and corporate partners. The Foundation's objectives align perfectly with UN Sustainable Development Goals: Quality Education, Decent Work and Economic Growth, and Reduced Inequalities.

The Foundation remains dedicated to reaching as many of India's 650,000+ villages as possible, driven by its mission to transform lives, enhance livelihoods, and elevate rural communities.